Rebuttal to Argument Against Measure J

The opposition asks voters to preserve *separate* elementary and high school districts in the name of "local control." But Measure J does not eliminate local control – it enhances it. It creates **locally governed unified school districts in both King City and Greenfield**, each with one elected board accountable to local voters for the success of each community's students from TK through grade 12.

Measure J creates a continuous educational system that aligns curriculum, student support, and academic pathways from the earliest grades through graduation. KCUSD's Dual Language Immersion program is not at risk under Measure J. Claims that elementary students will lose resources to high-school programs are speculation, not requirements of the measure.

The proposed reorganization has undergone extensive review – with participation from KCUSD and its representatives – and received unanimous approval from the **Monterey County Committee on School District Organization and the California State Board of Education**. A joint MOU supporting plans related to unification developed collaboratively has been adopted by GUSD, KCUSD, and SMCJUHSD.

Voters should also consider the perspectives supporting each position. The supporting statement was signed by the presidents of the **Greenfield Elementary and South Monterey County Joint Union High School District Boards, both of which unanimously support the reorganization**, putting community identity, local accountability, and a seamless experience for students and families ahead of their own institutional interests. The **mayors of King City and Greenfield and the local Monterey County Supervisor** also signed the supporting statement, demonstrating broad community support across the communities the measure would serve.

Measure J is about creating locally accountable TK–12 school districts designed to better serve students throughout their educational journey.

Names of Signers as they appear on the Required Argument Signature Statement

1. David Gaboni- Board President, SMCJUHSD
2. Mike LeBarre- Mayor, King City
3. Chris Lopez- Supervisor
4. Robert White- Mayor, Greenfield
5. Denise Jaime- Board President, GUSD

APPENDIX D – Required Argument Signature Statement

A ballot argument shall not be accepted unless accompanied by the printed name and signature or printed names and signatures of the person or persons submitting it, or, if submitted on behalf of an organization, the name of the organization and the printed name and signature of at least one of its principal officers (Elections Code §§9164, 9283, 9501.5).

No more than five signatures shall appear with any argument submitted under this article. In case any argument is signed by more than five persons, the signatures of the first five shall be printed (Elections Code §§9164, 9283, 9501.5).

All arguments concerning measures filed pursuant to this division shall be accompanied by the following form statement, to be ***signed by each proponent*** of the argument (Elections Code §9600):

"The undersigned proponent(s) or signer(s) of the:

☐ Primary argument in favor ☐ Primary argument against
☐ Rebuttal to argument in favor ☒ Rebuttal to argument against

ballot measure *(insert letter)* J at the ☐ Primary ☒ General ☐ Special

election for the Reorganization of South Monterey County Joint Union High School District into two Unified School Districts.
(jurisdiction – name of district)

to be held on November 3, 2026 hereby state that this argument is true and
(Election date)

correct to the best of his/her/their knowledge and belief."

Signatures of proponents (in order of appearance in the voter information guide): (SMCJUHSD)

(1) Printed Name David Gaboni Title (one) Board President
Date 8-20-26

(2) Printed Name Mike LeBarre Title (one) Mayor, King City
Date 8-20-2026

(3) Printed Name CHRIS LOPEZ Title (one) Supervisor
Date 8-20-2026

(4) Printed Name Robert White Title (one) MAYOR, GREENFIELD
Date 8-20-2026

(5) Printed Name Denise Jaime Title (one) GUSD Board President
Date 8/20/2026

Filer:

(1) Printed Name Dr. Laura Cortez Title (one) GUSD Superintendent
Date 8/20/2026